Fertilisers

Exam code: 0620 & 0971

Download PDF

Written by: Caroline Carroll
Reviewed by: Stewart Hird
Updated on 9 February 2025

Fertilisers

NPK fertilisers

- NPK fertilisers contain **nitrogen, potassium** and **phosphorus** for improved plant growth
  - Nitrogen makes chlorophyll and protein and promotes healthy **leaves**
  - Potassium promotes **growth** and healthy **fruit** and **flowers**
  - Phosphorus promotes healthy **roots**
- Fertiliser compounds contain the following water-soluble ions:
  - Ammonium ions, NH_4^+ and nitrate ions, NO_3^-, are sources of soluble nitrogen
  - Phosphate ions, PO_4^{3-} are a source of soluble phosphorus
  - Most common potassium compounds dissolve in water to produce potassium ions, K^+
- Ammonium salts and nitrate salts are commonly used as fertilisers, including:
  - Ammonium nitrate, NH_4NO_3
  - Ammonium phosphate, $(NH_4)_3PO_4$
  - Potassium nitrate, KNO_3
- Different fertilisers contain different amounts of fertiliser compounds
  - So, each fertiliser contains different proportions of nitrogen, potassium and phosphorous

Help me understand

Examiner Tips and Tricks

You may be asked to select a compound or combination of compounds from a list which would be the most effective as a fertiliser.

Look for the compound or combination of compounds that contain the most elements from nitrogen, phosphorous and potassium.

Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

New! Exclusive Teacher-Only Questions

- Fresh, expert-written questions
- Students can't access them
- Fair accurate tests - built fast

Explore in Test Builder

Test yourself

Flashcards

Was this revision note helpful? Yes No

Previous

Next

Course

Study tools

All topics

© Copyright 2015–2026 Save My Exams Ltd. All Rights Reserved.

Neither IBO nor College Board were involved in the production of, and do not endorse, the resources created by Save My Exams.